Burak Üren

Backend Engineer

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SUMMARY

Backend engineer with 4+ years of professional experience building REST APIs, async microservices (Celery, RabbitMQ, Redis) and payment-integrated systems with Django and Flask. Shipped Stripe billing, org-level RBAC and LMS integrations; cut repeated DB reads ~80%. Founded a 5,000+ user marketplace (API to server hardening); cut its infra cost 78%.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, SQL, Bash
Backend: Django, Django REST Framework, Flask, SQLAlchemy, Alembic, Celery, HTMX
Data & Messaging: PostgreSQL (incl. Full-Text Search), Redis, RabbitMQ, pandas
Cloud & Infra: AWS (RDS, S3, EKS, ElastiCache), DigitalOcean, Nginx, Caddy, Cloudflare, Linux
DevOps: Docker, Docker Compose, Kubernetes, Helm, GitHub Actions, Jenkins, Git, Grafana, Loki
Testing & Practices: pytest, factory-boy, mypy, black, flake8, isort, test-driven development, code review, Agile/Scrum
Architecture & Security: OpenAPI/Swagger, microservices, task queues, caching, RBAC, JWT, SOPS + age

EXPERIENCE

MatFabe Referral Web Application Mar 2026 – Present
Backend Engineer Full-time, Istanbul, Turkey

- Sole backend engineer; designed and built a tutoring referral platform (Django, HTMX, PostgreSQL) from scratch.
- Modeled a multi-level network of 60+ referrers and a stage-enforced outreach pipeline.
- Work test-first in Scrum iterations; pytest, factory-boy and mypy checks guard every release against regressions.
- Dockerized; GitHub Actions CI/CD ships versioned images to DigitalOcean Container Registry several times a week.

SMGrader.com Oct 2022 – Nov 2025
Backend Engineer Part-time, remote (Melbourne, Australia)
5-person engineering team, Scrum sprints, peer code review

- Built the REST API of an AI-powered grading platform (DRF) and 4 async microservices (Celery, RabbitMQ, Redis).
- Implemented organization-level role-based access control (RBAC) on Django's permission framework.
- Integrated Stripe billing with per-user token budgets that capped AI usage per paid plan.
- Designed a background job system (~200 jobs/day) with monitoring, task tracking and log-based debugging.
- Reduced AI call volume ~15–20% with graceful cancellation: a Redis flag stops cancelled jobs before any AI call.
- Cut repeated metadata DB reads ~80% via a Redis read-through cache (TTL) shared across background tasks.
- Added message logging and co-designed Grafana/Loki/Slack alerts with DevOps, halving triage (~1 h to ~30 min).
- Developed a bidirectional Canvas LMS integration (LTI and REST API) synchronizing data across ~20 courses.
- Shipped services on AWS (RDS, S3, EKS, ElastiCache), deployed via the team's Jenkins; supported Kubernetes scaling.

BanaDersBul.com Jan 2021 – Present
Founder, Backend Engineer Part-time, self-employed

- Launched a teacher-student marketplace for private lessons: 5,000+ users, 99.88% uptime; own backend and infra.
- Built the REST API with Flask, SQLAlchemy (Alembic), PostgreSQL Full-Text Search; documented in OpenAPI/Swagger.
- Cached search results in Redis keyed by a query hash, cutting repeat search latency 10x (~300 ms to ~30 ms).
- Implemented JWT auth (logins, secure file downloads, password resets, admin impersonation) and a Flask-Admin panel.
- Ran production on DigitalOcean Kubernetes for 4 years: Helm charts, Nginx ingress with TLS, resource limits, scaling.
- Then migrated to a self-managed Docker Compose server; dropping Kubernetes overhead cut hosting cost 78%.
- Built one-click GitHub Actions deploys with SOPS + age encrypted secrets; hardened SSH, UFW firewall, fail2ban.
- Shrank Docker images 80%+ (1.14 GB to 199 MB) and merged 3 repos into a monorepo; build and push ~10 to ~2 min.

EDUCATION

Istanbul Kultur University Sep 2022 – Jun 2026 (Graduated)
B.Sc. Mathematics and Computer Science

- Mentored student coders on the Patika.dev online coding platform; ran Linux community events.
- Erasmus+ Blended Intensive Programme (2026): cross-border project with EU partner universities.
- Published guest article on Teclado (2022): time complexity and Big O in Python.

LANGUAGES

Turkish (native), English (professional working proficiency)